

from the cold press of Banality by a timely bit of Glamour, as they cling to its warm spark in the oncoming darkness.

The Undoing

The force of Banality in the mortal world is so strong that, if a changeling is not careful, it can separate a fae from his mortal self. As a changeling is worn down by Banality, he starts to forget his connection to the Dreaming. Memories of his fae selves disappear and a fae may fall into the *Undoing*, a time when a changeling forgets his time as a fae and instead is subsumed into his mortal seeming altogether. Should the process not be halted or at least slowed, the changeling loses touch with his fae half entirely. What is left behind is the hollow mortal half, living his life alone in the dull, Banal world.

This process doesn't happen all at once. Changelings weather the forces of Banality every day, buffered from its harshest effects by their mortal seemings. By taking that bit of Banality into their lives, changelings can build up a tolerance and use the mortal half to shelter them from the worst that the cold Autumn world has to offer. A changeling's fae mien may dig down deep below her mortal shell to endure the most trying parts of her everyday life, from paying bills to dealing with tax officials. Prolonged contact with Banal influences can wear down even the toughest changeling and send her in a slow spiral towards the Undoing.

Fae have been using the trick of hiding behind mortal seemings for as long as memory stands. Faeries would wear

mortal disguises to walk among humanity, even going so far as to take the appearance of mortals to hide from those that might enslave them or destroy them with cold iron. This tactic was later used when the Shattering threatened to crush the fae left behind when the gates to Arcadia swung shut. Those who stayed in the mortal world used the trick of taking mortal form to create the Changeling Way Ritual that allowed the fae to be reborn in mortal bodies, protected (at least in part) from the Banal world.

This transformation by the fae into changelings didn't come without a cost. Changelings lose the memory of their fae selves when utterly subsumed into their mortal seemings. It's for this reason that, until Chrysalis, a mortal does not remember her fae self fully. It's possible that some fae souls never awaken from their slumber, their mortal seemings so buried in Banality that they cannot be reached by the Dreaming. They remain, tragically, lost to Banality's Undoing and the Mists.

The Mists

Once, long ago, the fae created barriers that would protect themselves and the wonders of the chimerical world from the prying eyes of humanity. Over time, the Mists merged with the rising Banality and transformed from a protection against mortal intrusion into a barrier between Kithain and the Dreaming. While this unseen cloud of disenchantment keeps mortals from recognizing fae magic and faerie miens when they see them, it also helps to cloud the mind of changelings while in their

